

Airfoil

The cross-section of a plane's wing has a shape called an airfoil, which forces air to speed up over the top surface and slow down beneath. The aerofoil is angled so that air passing under the wing is forced downward. Air passing over the wing is forced downward too. The angle also creates an area of very low pressure above the wing. As a result of the wing pushing the air downward and the pressure difference above and below the wing, the air pushes the wing (and plane) upward.

